

Widows



Character of true.

Luke 2:37 And she was a widow of about fourscore and four years, which departed not from the temple, but served God with fastings and prayers night and day.

1 Timothy 5:5 Now she that is a widow indeed, and desolate, trusteth in God, and continueth in supplications and prayers night and day.

1 Timothy 5:10 Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children, if she have lodged strangers, if she have washed the Saints' feet, if she have relieved the Afflicted, if she have diligently followed every good work.

GOD

Surely hears the cry of.

Exodus 22:23 If thou afflict them in any wise, and they cry at all unto me, I will surely hear their cry;

Judges for.

Deuteronomy 10:18 He doth execute the Judgment of the Fatherless and widow, and loveth the stranger, in giving him food and raiment.

Psalms 68:5 A Father of the Fatherless, and a Judge of the widows, is God in his holy habitation.

Relieves.

Psalms 146:9 The LORD preserveth the strangers; he relieveth the Fatherless and widow: but the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.

Establishes the border of.

Proverbs 15:25 The LORD will destroy the house of the proud: but he will establish the border of the widow.

Will Witness against oppressors of.

Malachi 3:5 And I will come near to you to Judgment; and I will be a swift Witness against the sorcerers, and against the adulterers, and against false swearers, and against those that oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the Fatherless, and that turn aside the stranger from his right, and fear not me, saith the LORD of hosts.

Exhorted to trust in God.

Jeremiah 49:11 Leave thy Fatherless children, I will preserve them alive; and let thy widows trust in me.

SHOULD NOT BE

Afflicted.

Exodus 22:22 Ye shall not afflict any widow, or Fatherless child.

Oppressed.

Jeremiah 7:6 If ye oppress not the stranger, the Fatherless, and the widow, and shed not innocent blood in this place, neither walk after other gods to your hurt:

Zechariah 7:10 And oppress not the widow, nor the Fatherless, the stranger, nor the poor; and let none of you imagine evil against his brother in your heart.

Treated with violence.

Jeremiah 22:3 Thus saith the LORD; Execute ye Judgment and righteousness, and deliver the spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor: and do no wrong, do no violence to the stranger, the Fatherless, nor the widow, neither shed innocent blood in this place.

Deprived of raiment in pledge.

Deuteronomy 24:17 Thou shalt not pervert the Judgment of the stranger, nor of the

Fatherless; nor take a widow's raiment to pledge:

SHOULD BE

Pleaded for.

Isaiah 1:17 Learn to do well; seek Judgment, relieve the oppressed, Judge the Fatherless, plead for the widow.

Honored, if widows indeed.

1 Timothy 5:3 Honour widows that are widows indeed.

Relieved by their friends.

1 Timothy 5:4 But if any widow have children or nephews, let them learn first to shew piety at home, and to requite their parents: for that is good and acceptable before God.

1 Timothy 5:16 If any man or woman that believeth have widows, let them relieve them, and let not the Church be charged; that it may relieve them that are widows indeed.

Relieved by the Church.

Acts 6:1 And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.

1 Timothy 5:9 Let not a widow be taken into the number under threescore years old, having been the wife of one man,

Visited in Affliction.

James 1:27 Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this, To visit the Fatherless and widows in their Affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.

Allowed to share in our blessings.

Deuteronomy 14:29 And the Levite, (because he hath no part nor inheritance with thee,) and the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, which are within thy gates, shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hand which thou doest.

Deuteronomy 16:11 And thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates, and the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, that are among you, in the place which the LORD thy God hath Chosen to place his name there.

Deuteronomy 24:19-21 When thou cuttest down thine harvest in thy field, and hast forgot a sheaf in the field, thou shalt not go again to fetch it: it shall be for the stranger, for the Fatherless, and for the widow: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hands. When thou beatest thine olive tree, thou shalt not go over the boughs again: it shall be for the stranger, for the Fatherless, and for the widow. When thou gatherest the grapes of thy vineyard, thou shalt not glean it afterward: it shall be for the stranger, for the Fatherless, and for the widow.

Though poor, may be liberal.

Mark 12:42-44 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing. And he called *unto him* his disciples, and saith unto them, **Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury: For all *they* did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, *even* all her living.**

When young, exposed to may temptations.

1 Timothy 5:11-14 But the younger widows refuse: for when they have begun to wax wanton against Christ, they will marry; Having damnation, because they have cast off their first Faith. And withal they learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house; and not only idle, but tattlers also and busybodies, speaking things which they ought not. I will therefore that the younger Women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully.

Saints

Relieve.

Acts 9:39 Then Peter arose and went with them. When he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber: and all the widows stood by him weeping, and shewing the Coats and garments which Dorcas made, while she was with them.

Cause joy to.

Job 29:13 The blessing of him that was ready to perish came upon me: and I caused the widow's heart to Sing for joy.

Disappoint not.

Job 31:16 If I have withheld the poor from their desire, or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail;

THE WICKED

Do no good to.

Job 24:21 He evil entreateth the barren that beareth not: and doeth not good to the widow.

Send, away empty.

Job 22:9 Thou hast sent widows away empty, and the arms of the Fatherless have been broken.

Take pledges from.

Job 24:3 They drive away the Ass of the Fatherless, they take the widow's ox for a pledge.

Reject the cause of.

Isaiah 1:23 Thy Princes are rebellious, and companions of Thieves: every one loveth gifts, and followeth after rewards: they Judge not the Fatherless, neither doth the cause of the widow come unto them.

Vex.

Ezekiel 22:7 In thee have they set Light by Father and mother: in the midst of thee have they dealt by oppression with the stranger: in thee have they vexed the Fatherless and the widow.

Make a prey of.

Isaiah 10:2 To turn aside the needy from Judgment, and to take away the right from the poor of my people, that widows may be their prey, and that they may rob the Fatherless!

Matthew 23:14 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye devour widows' houses, and for a pretence make long prayer: therefore ye shall receive the greater damnation.

Slay.

Psalm 94:6 They slay the widow and the stranger, and murder the Fatherless.

Curse for perverting Judgment of.

Deuteronomy 27:19 Cursed be he that perverteth the Judgment of the stranger, Fatherless, and widow. And all the people shall say, Amen.

Woe to those who oppress.

Isaiah 10:1-2 Woe unto them that decree unrighteous decrees, and that write grievousness which they have prescribed; 2 To turn aside the needy from Judgment, and to take away the right from the poor of my people, that widows may be their prey, and that they may rob the Fatherless!

Blessings on those who relieve.

Deuteronomy 14:29 And the Levite, (because he hath no part nor inheritance with thee,) and the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, which are within thy gates, shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hand which thou doest.

A type of Zion in Affliction.

Lamentations 5:3 We are orphans and Fatherless, our mothers are as widows.

Were released from all obligation to former husbands.

Romans 7:3 So then if, while her husband liveth, she be married to another man, she shall be called an adulteress: but if her husband be Dead, she is free from that law; so that she is no adulteress, though she be married to another man.

Were clothed in mourning after the decease of husbands.

Genesis 38:14 And she put her widow's garments off from her, and covered her with a vail, and wrapped herself, and sat in an open place, which is by the way to Timnath; for she saw that Shelah was grown, and she was not given unto him to wife.

Genesis 38:19 And she arose, and went away, and laid by her vail from her, and put on the garments of her widowhood.

2 Samuel 14:2 And Joab sent to Tekoah, and fetched thence a wise woman, and said unto her, I pray thee, feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on now mourning apparel, and anoint not thyself with oil, but be as a woman that had a long time mourned for the Dead:

2 Samuel 14:5 And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, I am indeed a widow woman, and mine husband is Dead.

Reproach connected with.

Isaiah 54:4 Fear not; for thou shalt not be ashamed: neither be thou confounded; for thou shalt not be put to shame: for thou shalt forget the shame of thy youth, and shalt not remember the reproach of thy widowhood any more.

Increase of, threatened as a punishment.

Exodus 22:24 And my wrath shall wax hot, and I will kill you with the sword; and your wives shall be widows, and your children Fatherless.

Jeremiah 15:8 Their widows are increased to me above the sand of the seas: I have brought upon them against the mother of the young men a spoiler at noonday: I have caused him to fall upon it suddenly, and terrors upon the city.

Jeremiah 18:21 Therefore deliver up their children to the famine, and pour out their blood by the force of the sword; and let their wives be bereaved of their children, and be widows; and let their men be put to Death; let their young men be slain by the sword in battle.

LAWS RESPECTING;

Not to be oppressed.

Exodus 22:22 Ye shall not afflict any widow, or Fatherless child.

Deuteronomy 27:19 Cursed be he that perverteth the Judgment of the stranger, Fatherless, and widow. And all the people shall say, Amen.

Raiment of, not to be taken in pledge by creditors.

Deuteronomy 24:17 Thou shalt not pervert the Judgment of the stranger, nor of the Fatherless; nor take a widow's raiment to pledge:

Bound to perform their vows.

Numbers 30:9 But every vow of a widow, and of her that is divorced, wherewith they have bound their souls, shall stand against her.

Not to intermarry with priests.

Leviticus 21:14 A widow, or a divorced woman, or profane, or an harlot, these shall he not take: but he shall take a virgin of his own people to wife.

To be allowed to glean in fields and vineyards.

Deuteronomy 24:19 When thou cuttest down thine harvest in thy field, and hast forgot a sheaf in the field, thou shalt not go again to fetch it: it shall be for the stranger, for the Fatherless, and for the widow: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hands.

To have a share of the triennial tithe.

Deuteronomy 14:28 At the end of three years thou shalt bring forth all the tithe of thine increase the same year, and shalt lay it up within thy gates:

Deuteronomy 26:12-13 When thou hast made an end of tithing all the tithes of thine increase the third year, which is the year of tithing, and hast given it unto the Levite, the stranger, the Fatherless, and the widow, that they may eat within thy gates, and be filled; Then thou shalt say before the LORD thy God, I have brought away the hallowed things out of mine house, and also have given them unto the Levite, and unto the stranger, to the Fatherless, and to the widow, according to all thy commandments which thou hast commanded me: I have not transgressed thy commandments, neither have I forgotten them:

To share in public rejoicings.

Deuteronomy 16:11 And thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates, and the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, that are among you, in the place which the LORD thy God hath Chosen to place his name there.

Deuteronomy 16:14 And thou shalt rejoice in thy feast, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite, the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, that are within thy gates.

When daughters of priests and childless, to partake of the holy things.

Leviticus 22:13 But if the priest's daughter be a widow, or divorced, and have no child, and is returned unto her Father's house, as in her youth, she shall eat of her Father's meat: but there shall no stranger eat thereof.

When left childless, to be married by their husband's nearest of kin.

Deuteronomy 25:5-6 If Brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the Dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband's brother shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband's brother unto her. And it shall be, that the firstborn which she beareth shall succeed in the name of his brother which is Dead, that his name be not put out of Israel.

Allowed to marry again.

Romans 7:3 So then if, while her husband liveth, she be married to another man, she shall be called an adulteress: but if her husband be Dead, she is free from that law; so

that she is no adulteress, though she be married to another man.

Intermarrying with, of kings considered treason.

1 Kings 2:21-24 And she said, Let Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah thy brother to wife. And king Solomon answered and said unto his mother, And why dost thou ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? ask for him the kingdom also; for he is mine elder brother; even for him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for Joab the son of Zeruiah. 23 Then king Solomon swore by the LORD, saying, God do so to me, and more also, if Adonijah have not spoken this word against his own life. 24 Now therefore, as the LORD liveth, which hath established me, and set me on the throne of David my Father, and who hath made me an house, as he promised, Adonijah shall be put to Death this day.

Not to be deplored by, considered a great calamity.

Job 27:15 Those that remain of him shall be buried in Death: and his widows shall not weep.

Psalms 78:64 Their priests fell by the sword; and their widows made no lamentation.

Were under the special protection of God.

Deuteronomy 10:18 He doth execute the Judgment of the Fatherless and widow, and loveth the stranger, in giving him food and raiment.

Psalms 68:5 A Father of the Fatherless, and a Judge of the widows, is God in his holy habitation.

Were frequently oppressed and persecuted.

Job 24:3 They drive away the Ass of the Fatherless, they take the widow's ox for a pledge.

Ezekiel 22:7 In thee have they set Light by Father and mother: in the midst of thee have they dealt by oppression with the stranger: in thee have they vexed the Fatherless and the widow.

Specially taken care of by the primitive Church.

Acts 6:1 And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.

1 Timothy 5:9 Let not a widow be taken into the number under threescore years old, having been the wife of one man,

Often devoted themselves entirely to God's service.

Luke 2:37 And she was a widow of about fourscore and four years, which departed not from the temple, but served God with fastings and prayers night and day.

1 Timothy 5:10 Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children, if she have lodged strangers, if she have washed the Saints' feet, if she have relieved the Afflicted, if she have diligently followed every good work.

Instances of great liberality in.

1 Kings 17:9-15 Arise, get thee to Zarephath, which *belongeth* to Zidon, and dwell there: behold, I have commanded a widow woman there to sustain thee. So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, behold, the widow woman was there gathering of sticks: and he called to her, and said, Fetch me, I pray thee, a little water in a vessel, that I may drink. And as she was going to fetch *it*, he called to her, and said, Bring me, I pray thee, a morsel of bread in thine hand. And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a cruse: and, behold, I *am* gathering two sticks, that I may go in and

dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die. And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go *and* do as thou hast said: but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring *it* unto me, and after make for thee and for thy son. For thus saith the LORD God of Israel, The barrel of meal shall not waste, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day *that* the LORD sendeth rain upon the earth. And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat *many* days.

Mark 12:42-44 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing. And he called *unto him* his disciples, and saith unto them, *Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury: For all *they* did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, *even* all her living.*

ILLUSTRATIVE OF

A desolate condition.

Isaiah 47:8-9 Therefore hear now this, thou that Art given to pleasures, that dwellest carelessly, that sayest in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me; I shall not sit as a widow, neither shall I know the loss of children: But these two things shall come to thee in a moment in one day, the loss of children, and widowhood: they shall come upon thee in their perfection for the multitude of thy sorceries, and for the great Abundance of thine enchantments.

Zion in captivity.

Lamentations 1:1 How doth the city sit solitary, that was full of people! how is she become as a widow! she that was great among the nations, and [Princess] among the provinces, how is she become tributary!